

SWETHA THANABALAN

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Product Designer experienced in translating user research into interaction decisions, functional prototypes, developer handoffs, and shipped product updates across education, gaming, and AI-assisted services.

EXPERIENCE

Adult You - User Experience Designer

Philadelphia, PA | Sep 2025 - Aug 2026

- Owned end-to-end product design for a gamified education platform, translating educational goals into learning journeys, onboarding flows, and engagement mechanics.
- Partnered with the CEO and a Unity developer to translate product concepts into user flows, interaction patterns, and a functional build, reviewing implementation for alignment with the intended experience.
- Led user research through a group feedback session with approximately 20 college students and a comparative Maze study, identifying content comprehension, question fatigue, and interaction structure as barriers to engagement.
- Presented the findings to leadership, shifting the team from concept evaluation to customer discovery and developing a survey to reassess target-customer assumptions, learning behaviors, and content priorities.

Talofa Games - Product Designer

Cupertino, CA | Jun 2025 - Aug 2025

- Led user research into barriers within the Welcome Back experience, finding that returning players needed stronger motivation and clearer cues about their progress and next actions.
- Redesigned the re-engagement flow using personalized progress cues and familiar game elements, helping players recognize previous achievements and identify their next actions.
- Tested the redesigned experience with eight geographically distributed early adopters, whose feedback supported personalized monster-based progress cues as a clearer and more motivating direction.
- Created annotated developer handoff documentation and facilitated sprint reviews, supporting live-game implementation of expanded monster interactions and a companion behavior where the monster walks alongside the player.

SELECTED PROJECT

Sahay - Product Designer

Drexel University Capstone | Jan 2026 - Jun 2026

- Investigated how people respond to home-maintenance problems through a survey of 16 respondents and six user interviews, identifying decision uncertainty and demand for ongoing issue and maintenance tracking.
- Translated the findings into an information architecture and early flows centered on helping users understand an issue before deciding whether to pursue DIY guidance or professional support.
- Tested the information architecture and early flows with six participants using realistic maintenance scenarios, supporting the issue-first direction while revealing the need for clearer terminology, AI transparency, and visible trust indicators.
- Designed the final mobile-first experience around AI-assisted issue assessment and expanded the original scope to include issue tracking, appliance management, and searchable repair and maintenance histories.

SKILLS

Product Design: Product Discovery, Interaction Design, Information Architecture, User Flows, Prototyping, Design Systems, Accessibility

Research: Interviews, Surveys, Usability Testing, Concept Testing, A/B Testing, Competitive Analysis

Collaboration: Stakeholder Alignment, Developer Handoff, Design QA, Sprint Reviews

Tools: Figma, Maze, UserTesting, Miro, ProtoPie, Adobe Creative Suite, Claude, Kiro

EDUCATION

Drexel University - Master of Science, Human-Computer Interaction & User Experience | Jun 2026 | GPA: 4.0

Fanshawe College - Post Grad Diploma, Public Relations - Corporate Communication | May 2021 | GPA: 4.03 | **Presidential Honor**

University of Madras - Bachelor of Science, Visual Communication | April 2019 | GPA: 7.3